

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, May 9, 2018, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O'Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Jeremy Zullo
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Also present:

Ryan McNutt, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett said the Fee Schedule would be withdrawn with one exception. She said the Fee Schedule would be pulled because the Finance Committee needs to do in-depth analyses to crosscheck ordinances and the fees contained in them. Mr. McNutt said this was discussed at Staff Meeting and none of the fees are time sensitive except for the landlord form to be included with the tax bill.

Mayor Lovett said if the Council approved the Fee Schedule going to the Finance Committee, the Committee will take each section of the Fee Schedule, working with the City Manager and the appropriate Department Head, and will go through to make sure the fees in the ordinances are captured on the Fee Schedule. Mayor Lovett offered to take public comment on the Fee Schedule as a whole now. No one spoke.

Mayor Lovett said Item J Refuse Tax Deed is being rescheduled to May 23.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne to accept the minutes of the April 11, 2018, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Mr. O'Hearne said the April 17, 2018, minutes were from the joint meeting of the Council and School Board. He questioned how to approve. It was the consensus of the Council to move the approval to the next joint meeting.

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mr. McNutt said Public Works Appreciation Week is May 20-26. There will be a cook-out on May 22, 1 p.m., at Public Works and the Council is invited.

Mayor Lovett thanked the Councilors and public who were involved in the community-wide cleanup. 143 contractor bags and 654 tires were picked up.

Mayor Lovett asked Mr. Koloski about the cleanup plans for the 22nd. He said he is working on it and as soon as details are available, he'll send the information to the Council.

Mayor Lovett's notes:

- Saturday, May 12, budget presentation
- May 15, 6 p.m., CSB Community Center (CSBCC), public hearing regarding the East Street sidewalk and Bobby Woodman Trail
- May 18 River Valley Community College (RVCC) graduation at Claremont Opera House. Colors are blue and teal. She suggested downtown businesses could dress up their windows in blue and teal.
- Public Works Appreciation Week is May 20-26. Council will make a presentation.
- May 22 presentation on lead in the soil at CSBCC
- May 28 Memorial Day Parade
- RVCC was the recipient of Running Start Champion Award and Carrie Belknap-Morris received the 2018 Gwen & Henry Morgan Award.

Mr. Damren said the search process for a new RVCC President has been narrowed down to two finalists: Alfred Williams, northeastern Connecticut, and Cory LeClair, Assistant Superintendent, Claremont.

Mr. Koloski praised Public Works for rescuing a baby duck from a storm drain.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. McNutt said hydrant flushing will be May 14-May 23.

Mr. Damren noted that most of the proposed \$300,000 in road paving for next year will be spent in neighborhoods.

Mayor Lovett said the new City K-9, Maverick, "Ricky," will meet the Council in August.

Mr. McNutt said according to Kevin LaCasse, the work on the Goddard Building will begin the first week in July.

Mr. McNutt said Public Works will sweep downtown in order to be ready for the Memorial Day Parade and the June 6 Alumni Parade. He has contacted some building owners on Pleasant Street about beautifying their areas ahead of these two events.

Mayor Lovett gave kudos to the Claremont Gardening Club for their work on the side of City Hall. Mr. McNutt said there are plans to add more plantings under the tree in front of City Hall.

Mr. McNutt said vacant Washington Street spaces are starting to fill. The former Ford dealership went to auction and will become a VIP Service Center and the current VIP will become an O'Reilly Parts Store. The former Staples will become Harbor Freight Tools. Hobby Lobby is working on the K-Mart spot. The former Rite-Aid is still vacant.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Parks and Recreation Commission

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne to re-appoint Eric Zengota to seat #Alternate 2 – Ward II of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to re-appoint Jim Feleen to seat #2 – Ward II of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. O'Hearne to re-appoint Sheila Rook to seat #Alternate 3 – At Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Koloski to re-appoint Melissa Richmond to seat #Alternate 4 – At-Large of the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Chuck Cramer, New Aces Taxi, 20 Schmitt Street, said he started a taxi service seven years ago. He said he had a taxi license, but when he reapplied, it was difficult. He went to Newport and got a Newport license. He's been picking up passengers in Claremont for five years with no issues, but now he has to get a Claremont license. He has licenses from other communities. He claims the City Manager is hostile toward his service. He asked that the license approval go through the Police Department. He feels Chief Chase is supportive of his service. He said his

taxi fees are lower than others. Mayor Lovett asked when he applied for his license. Mr. Cramer said he hasn't applied yet. He said he has issues finding individuals that suit the insurance requirements of Claremont. He said no other communities exclude felons. He's having difficulty finding people to drive in Claremont that don't have felonies or DWIs on their records.

Oliver Beeman, fourth grader who lives on South Street, asked that the speed limit on South Street be reduced. He said cars exceed the 30-mph speed limit. He asked that it be reduced to 20 mph at all times. He also asked to reduce the speed limit on Chestnut Street before it turns onto South Street. He presented a petition to the Council with 45 signatures on it; some were children.

Mayor Lovett recommended this go to the Traffic Advisory Committee (TAC) for input. This will go on the May 23rd Council agenda. She invited Mr. Beeman back to the May 23rd Council meeting.

NEW BUSINESS

City Fee Schedule – Public Hearing

Mary Walter, Finance Director, said the state requires landlords/agents to fill out a Landlord/Agent Registration Form. There is a \$100 penalty for not filling it out. The City is asking the Council to approve a \$15 fee for filing the form. It is important to have this form on file for Code Enforcement. She wants to include the notice as a tax bill insert.

Mr. Pope asked where the \$15 fee goes. Ms. Walter said it goes toward staff time. She checked the amount other communities charge. The \$100 Restricted Property Landlord Agent Failure to File penalty is set by state statute. It was already on the Fee Schedule; this is a request to update the title.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Stone to approve the \$15 Restricted Property Landlord Agent Filing Fee.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Sullivan County ATV Club Annual Trail Permission

Steve Wilke, President Sullivan County ATV Club, said the Club maintains 45 miles of trails in Claremont, Unity and Cornish. This is the annual request for permission to use City-owned trails. Mr. Wilke said the Club plans to look at all the trails for maintenance.

Mr. Koloski asked if the Council wanted to consider making this a two-year permission. Because there was no notice to the change, Council agreed to leave it as is.

Mayor Lovett said Council will look at the statute and make a recommendation to the City Manager.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. O’Hearne that the Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 215-A:15, hereby authorizes the city manager, or his designees, to take such actions as may be necessary to issue a written Permission for Wheeled Vehicle Trail Access to the Sullivan County ATV Club for a period of one year from the expiration of the current Permission. This Permission is for use of designated City-owned land and class VI highways, which lists are to be included with the Permission Form and is subject to all City and state rules and regulations pertaining to use of ATVs and other off-highway recreational vehicles on public property. This Permission is granted subject to the following conditions:

- 1. The City may close one or more parcels of land, trails or roads to ATV use for reasons including but not limited to trail conditions, maintenance and public safety.**

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Request to Dedicate Fire Ladder-2 to Rick Bergeron – Public Hearing

Fire Chief Bryan Burr had submitted a request to the Council to dedicate the 2014 Emergency One “Quint,” also known as a combination 110” ladder/1500 GPM pumper, for retired Fire Chief Rick Bergeron. Chief Bergeron was instrumental in its specifications and design. [The words “Dedicated to Rick Bergeron, Years of Service 1977-2017” will be placed on the doors.]

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to allow the 2014 Emergency One “Quint” to be dedicated to Rick Bergeron, Years of Service 1977-2017.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Mr. McNutt said he is highly in favor of this. Rick Bergeron is one of the best fire chiefs he has worked with. He was incredibly dedicated to this City and this is a fitting tribute.

Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Mr. Pope summed up the policy. This will need 2/3 vote of the Council.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to amend the motion to add language to the motion to indicate that the pinstriping, lettering, time and material are donated, resulting in no cost to the City.

Roll call vote on the amendment:

Lessard - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Damren - yes

Zullo - yes
Kier - yes
Koloski - yes
Pope - yes
Lovett – yes
Motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to allow the 2014 Emergency One “Quint” to be dedicated to Rick Bergeron, Years of Service 1977-2017. The pinstriping, lettering, time and material are donated, resulting in no cost to the City.

Roll call vote on the amended motion:

Lessard - yes
O’Hearne - yes
Stone - yes
Damren - yes
Zullo - yes
Kier - yes
Koloski - yes
Pope - yes
Lovett – yes
Motion carried 9-0.

Mayor Lovett asked about the status of signage for the Santagate Bridge. Mr. O’Hearne said the citizens haven’t applied for their seats. Mr. Pope said it is currently a one-person committee. Mayor Lovett said she will make a note because it needs to be done.

Resolution 2018-27 Establish Emergency Plant Replacement Reserve-Water – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a Capital Reserve Fund for the purpose of funding unanticipated emergency repairs to the City's water system infrastructure for such unanticipated events as water main breaks, pump failures, etc.; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish such a Capital Reserve Fund will be transferred initially from the Water Enterprise Retained Earnings; and

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that, pursuant to RSA 35:7, there is established a Water Emergency Plant Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for the City's Water Department for the purpose of funding unanticipated emergency repairs to the City's water system infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the total Water Emergency Plant Replacement Capital Reserve Fund balance shall not exceed, on an annual basis, two percent (2%) of the book value of the existing water utility infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to transfer the sum of \$ 383,098.00 from the Water Enterprise Retained Earnings to the Water Emergency Plant Replacement Capital Reserve Fund and to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(Majority Vote Required)*

Mayor Lovett said all six of the following resolutions have been vetted by the Finance Committee.

Mr. Damren said these will help show the health of the water and sewer funds. The resolutions do not include future rate increases.

Ms. Walter said to take money out of the Fund, requires Council approval.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2018-27 Establish Emergency Plant Replacement Reserve-Water.

Ms. Kier read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-28 Establish Stabilization and Contingency Reserve-Water – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a Water Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund for the purpose of 1) funding operating revenue shortfalls resulting from variations in water usage, 2) providing a financial buffer in order to minimize the need for annual rate changes in response to the variability of annual expenditures, and 3) giving the City Council the ability to defer water rate increases to the extent they may result in a spike to the water users' fees, as well as 4) avoiding disruption to the water distribution system in the event of a catastrophic loss or damage to water infrastructure; and

WHEREAS the intent of establishing a Water Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund is to provide stability to the Water rate structure, understanding that said Fund is not intended to replace or offset the need for on-going, long-term water fee structure changes; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish such a Capital Reserve Fund will be transferred initially from the Water Enterprise Retained Earnings;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that, pursuant to RSA 35:7, there is established a Water Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund for the City's Water Department for the purpose of stabilizing the Water rate structure, as described above; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the total Water Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund balance shall not exceed, on an annual basis, twenty-five percent (25%) of the book value of the existing water utility infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to transfer the sum of \$454,184.00 from the Water Enterprise Retained Earnings to the Water Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund and to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. (*Majority Vote Required*)

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Koloski to adopt Resolution 2018-28 Establish Stabilization and Contingency Reserve-Water.

Mr. Damren read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-29 Establish Stabilization and Contingency Reserve-Sewer – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a Sewer Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund for the purpose of 1) funding operating revenue shortfalls resulting from variations in sewer usage, 2) providing a financial buffer in order to minimize the need for annual rate changes in response to the variability of annual expenditures, and 3) giving the City Council the ability to defer sewer rate increases to the extent they may result in a spike to the sewer users' fees, as well as 4) avoiding disruption to the sewer collection system in the event of a catastrophic loss or damage to sewer infrastructure; and

WHEREAS the intent of establishing a Sewer Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund is to provide stability to the Sewer rate structure, understanding that said Fund is not intended to replace or offset the need for on-going, long-term sewer fee structure changes; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish such a Capital Reserve Fund will be transferred initially from the retained earnings of the Sewer Enterprise Fund;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that, pursuant to RSA 35:7, there is established a Sewer Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund for the City's Sewer Department for the purpose of stabilizing the Sewer rate structure, as described above; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the total Sewer Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund balance shall not exceed, on an annual basis, twenty-five percent (25%) of the book value of the existing sewer utility infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to transfer the sum of \$576,912 from the Sewer Enterprise Retained Earnings to the Sewer Stabilization and Contingency Capital Reserve Fund and to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(Majority Vote Required)*

A motion was made by Mr. Zullo and seconded by Mr. O’Hearne to adopt Resolution 2018-29 Establish Stabilization and Contingency Reserve-Sewer.

Mr. Zullo read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-30 Establish Emergency Plant Replacement Reserve-Sewer – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a Capital Reserve Fund for the purpose of funding unanticipated emergency repairs to the City's sewer system infrastructure for such unanticipated events as sewer main breaks, pump failures, etc.; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish such a Capital Reserve Fund will be transferred initially from the Sewer Enterprise Retained Earnings;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that, pursuant to RSA 35:7, there is established a Sewer Emergency Plant Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for the City's Sewer Department for the purpose of funding unanticipated emergency repairs to the City's sewer system infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the total Sewer Emergency Plant Replacement Capital Reserve Fund balance shall not exceed, on an annual basis, two percent (2%) of the book value of the existing sewer utility infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to transfer the sum of \$ 580,637.00 from the Sewer Enterprise Retained Earnings to the Sewer Emergency Plant Replacement Capital Reserve Fund and to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(Majority Vote Required)*

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. O’Hearne to adopt Resolution 2018-30 Establish Emergency Plant Replacement Reserve-Sewer.

Mr. Koloski read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett asked, in the body of the resolution, to add infrastructure after plant.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. O’Hearne, in the body of the resolution to add infrastructure after plant.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote on the amendment: motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. O’Hearne to adopt Resolution 2018-30 Establish Emergency Plant Replacement Reserve-Sewer and in the body of the resolution to add infrastructure after plant.

Voice vote on the amended motion: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-31 Establish System Replacement Reserve-Sewer – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a Sewer System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for the purpose of funding upgrades and replacement of existing sewer system and plant infrastructure; and

WHEREAS utility industry practices use annual depreciation as a benchmark for funding such utility system replacement reserves; and

WHEREAS the intent of establishing a Sewer System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund is to upgrade and replace existing infrastructure through user rates from Sewer System ratepayers to the greatest extent possible as permitted by law and regulation; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish such a Capital Reserve Fund will be transferred initially from the 2017 Fiscal Year Sewer Enterprise Fund Balance;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that, pursuant to RSA 35:7, there is established a Sewer System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for the City's Sewer Department for the purpose of funding upgrades and replacement of sewer system and plant infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the goal of the Sewer System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund shall be to contribute, on an annual basis, ten percent (10%) of the depreciated value of the existing Sewer System infrastructure until one hundred percent (100%) of the depreciation expense is funded; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the goal of the Sewer System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for funding for new Sewer System infrastructure shall be to contribute, on an annual basis, the applicable percentage of depreciated value of its useful life until one hundred percent (100%) of its depreciation expense is reserved; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to transfer the sum of \$ 1,616,730.00 from the Sewer Enterprise Retained Earnings to the Sewer

System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund and to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(Majority Vote Required)*

A motion was made by Ms. Lessard and seconded by Mr. Pope to adopt Resolution 2018-31 Establish System Replacement Reserve-Sewer.

Ms. Lessard read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-32 Establish System Replacement Reserve-Water – Public Hearing

WHEREAS the City has determined there is a need to establish a Water System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for the purpose of funding upgrades and replacement of existing water system and plant infrastructure; and

WHEREAS utility industry practices use annual depreciation as a benchmark for funding such utility system replacement reserves; and

WHEREAS the intent of establishing a Water System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund is to upgrade and replace existing infrastructure through user rates from Water System ratepayers to the greatest extent possible as permitted by law and regulation; and

WHEREAS the monies needed to establish such a Capital Reserve Fund will be transferred initially from the Water Enterprise Fund Balance;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that, pursuant to RSA 35:7, there is established a Water System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for the City's Water Department for the purpose of funding upgrades and replacement of water system and plant infrastructure; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the goal of the Water System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund shall be to contribute, on an annual basis, five percent (5%) of the depreciated value of the existing Water System infrastructure until one hundred percent (100%) of the depreciation expense is funded; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the goal of the Water System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund for funding for new Water System infrastructure shall be to contribute, on an annual basis, the applicable percentage of depreciated value of its useful life until one hundred percent (100%) of its depreciation expense is reserved; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to transfer the sum of \$ 490,198.00 from the Water Enterprise retained earnings to the Water

System Replacement Capital Reserve Fund and also to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to implement this resolution. *(Majority Vote Required)*

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Koloski to adopt Resolution 2018-32 Establish System Replacement Reserve-Water.

Mr. Pope read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Scott Sweet, Public Works Director, said there are a few capital projects coming up. A study was done of the Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP). We are under the limit for phosphorus and nitrogen. The electrical system at the WWTP is very old and the City should look at replacing it ASAP. They estimate the cost will be \$1.5 million. Some blowers have been in place since 1985 and replacement will cost about \$500,000. There will be some efficiencies and we will go from four to three blowers.

Mr. Sweet talked about the success of jetting the water line from White Water Reservoir to the Water Treatment Plant (WTP) which is more than a mile. Cleaning out the line means we are able to keep up with the water demand and not having to pump water from the Sugar River.

Mayor Lovett asked for an update on the Broad Street water main break. Mr. Sweet said there was a crack in the pipe, which was almost 100 years old. It happened around noon or 1 p.m. on Saturday and the road was re-opened by 5 p.m. No basements were flooded.

Refuse Tax Deed

Moved to the May 23, 2018, Council meeting.

Tax Bill Insert – Landlord/Agent Registration Form

Ms. Walter said this is a request to allow the notice to property landlords/agents to be inserted in the tax bill.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Kier that the Claremont City Council, pursuant to RSA 76:11, hereby authorizes insertion of "Landlord/Agent Registration Form," regarding the requirement for certain landlords to file a Landlord/Agent Registration Form with the City, in the next tax bill mailings.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Preliminary Budget Discussions

Councilors discussed operational aspects of the Saturday, May 12th, budget meeting. There was a consensus of the Council that citizens would be allowed to speak for five minutes on non-agenda items during Citizen's Forum and then after each department budget presentation, citizens would be allowed to speak for up to three minutes.

Mayor Lovett suggested Councilors look at the department budgets on a macro level. One of the questions should be what does the Council expect the departments to achieve with their budgets.

Mr. Koloski asked for more information regarding the \$100,000 for preliminary study for downtown. Mr. McNutt said there is no study. You need pre-engineering grants, this is money to begin doing the front-end work to get everything ready for the next stage.

Ms. Kier asked if there will be public input for the Pleasant Street project. Mr. McNutt said yes, many opportunities. There have been stakeholder meetings to begin the design input phase, mostly centered around parking. We will have public hearings to receive public input.

Mr. Koloski asked what we get for the \$100,000. He asked if there is any benefit going back to a Main Street USA designation.

Mr. McNutt said we don't know everything we will get for the \$100,000. He said it is within the Goals & Objectives that were approved by this Council to revitalize our downtown, Pleasant Street in particular. The largest component of work will be pre-engineering toward doing utility upgrades.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Mayor Lovett said a letter has been received from the Conservation Commission requesting reassignment of jurisdiction of the Rail Trail to the Parks & Recreation Department. That is on the May 23 agenda.

Mr. McNutt said legal guidance from Gardner Fulton & Waugh regarding transfer of the Rail Trail from the Conservation Commission will be sent to the Council.

Mayor Lovett said Congresswoman Kuster recognized past and present members of the Amtrak Ad Hoc Committee on the Hill. The work done by the Committee was used by Congresswoman Kuster to craft legislation regarding the pre-clearance facility.

Mr. Pope said the Historic District Commission still has vacant seats.

Mr. Pope said the Policy Committee will meet May 17, 6 p.m.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Ms. Kier said she is becoming increasingly frustrated over receiving short notice for events. She asked for more timely notice of events.

Mr. Koloski said the tax deeded property auction is coming up, but there is no mention on the City's website. Mr. McNutt said it has been advertised. He will follow-up.

Mr. Koloski said the Personnel Advisory Board is in violation of the Charter. Mayor Lovett said the Council has to make an appointment to the Board. She will put out a specific notice on CCTV (Claremont Community Television) asking for applicants.

Mr. O'Hearne asked to have a discussion about the makeup of the boards, commissions and committees (composition and underlying statutes). Mayor Lovett said that discussion probably could be in June.

Mayor Lovett talked about having a presentation from the Planning and Development Department at the June 13 meeting, so the Council will have a firm understanding where Planning is going.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:54 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Zullo to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council